📗 Facilitator

Facilitator Guide

Copilot Studio Workshop — Delivery Flow & Recovery

Copilot Studio Workshop · Generated March 21, 2026

Copilot Studio Workshop Facilitator Guide

Workshop goals

This two-day workshop helps customers move from foundational Copilot Studio concepts to a practical, enterprise-shaped multi-agent scenario. By the end of the event, participants should be able to build, ground, test, and publish agents on Day 1, then extend that foundation into a governed Hiring Agent solution on Day 2.

Primary goals:

- Build confidence with Copilot Studio for mixed audiences.
- Show how makers, IT pros, and developers each contribute to a shared agent delivery lifecycle.
- Connect foundational agent authoring to enterprise patterns such as orchestration, safety, data grounding, document generation, MCP-enabled operations, and built-in evaluation.
- Leave each participant with clear next steps for production readiness.

Audience profile

This workshop is designed for mixed customer cohorts:

- [Maker] Business technologists and power users who will design prompts, topics, cards, and flows.
- [IT Pro] Platform owners, tenant admins, and governance leads who care about environments, security, publishing, licensing, and controls.
- [Developer] Engineers and architects who want solution packaging, extensibility, data integration, MCP-based tooling, and a VS Code-centered workflow.

Recommended baseline:

- Comfortable using Microsoft 365 and web apps.
- Familiarity with Power Platform concepts is helpful but not required for Day 1.
- Day 2 assumes Day 1 familiarity, a completed Recruit badge, or equivalent hands-on Copilot Studio experience.

> **Note:** If several attendees skip Day 1, open Day 2 with a stricter prerequisite check and be ready to pair them with stronger table groups.

Dry-run automation helpers

Use the PowerShell toolkit in `../automation/` when you want a repeatable facilitator setup without consuming the student-owned lab work.

Recommended flow:

1. Copy `workshop/automation/workshop-config.example.json` to `workshop/automation/workshop-config.json` and replace the tenant, SharePoint, environment, and `SharePoint.PnPClientId` placeholders. Keep the default Day 2 asset paths if you plan to localize the Lab 13 files into `workshop\assets`, or update those paths if you store the files elsewhere. `SharePoint.PnPLoginMode` defaults to `DeviceLogin` for terminal-friendly sign-in.
2. Run `Install-WorkshopPrerequisites.ps1` once on the facilitator machine to install `PnP.PowerShell` and confirm that `pac` is available.
3. Use the Day 2 asset download helper to localize `Operative_1_0_0_0.zip`, `job-roles.csv`, and `evaluation-criteria.csv` from the public Microsoft `agent-academy` Operative Mission 01 source into `workshop\assets`; this prepares local input files only and does not import anything into Power Platform for you. Lab 13 now directs participants to the local `workshop/assets/` copies first, so confirm these files are present before delivery.
4. Run `Invoke-WorkshopPrereqCheck.ps1` to validate the required local tools, populated config values, and localized Day 2 asset paths; it does not download the files, test live SharePoint access, or execute tenant settings for you.
5. Run `Invoke-WorkshopLabSetup.ps1 -Mode StudentReady` to pre-stage Lab 00 shared prerequisites by creating the shared `Contoso IT` site, core lists, sample data, and any optional SharePoint artifacts enabled in config while preserving later student-owned work such as Labs 09, 13, and 16 plus the broader agent, MCP, Teams, and evaluation exercises.
6. Run `Import-WorkshopOperativeAssets.ps1 -ImportSolution` only against a separate facilitator demo environment when you intentionally want the Lab 13 solution package pre-staged; it imports only the solution ZIP, not the CSV data import, agent creation, or later Day 2 labs.

> **Operator expectation:** SharePoint setup uses PnP PowerShell sign-in with the configured Entra app client ID and defaults to `DeviceLogin` unless you switch `SharePoint.PnPLoginMode` to `Interactive`. Any solution import uses the currently authenticated `pac` profile. Verify both point to the intended tenant and demo environment before running the scripts.

Suggested delivery flow

Day 1: Recruit foundations

Use Day 1 to create shared language and shared wins. Keep the pace brisk through concepts, then maximize keyboard time once participants enter guided build modules.

Suggested pattern:

1. Welcome and environment check.
2. Short framing on agents, scenarios, and workshop outcomes.
3. Guided tour of Copilot Studio fundamentals.
4. Structured build sequence through declarative patterns, solutions, prebuilt agents, and custom agent concepts.
5. Hands-on work through knowledge, topics, cards, flows, triggers, publishing, and the Day 1 licensing close.
6. End-of-day recap tied to Recruit badge or equivalent readiness.

Recommended labs to reference:

- Lab 00 - Environment Setup
- Lab 01 - Intro to Agents
- Lab 02 - Copilot Studio Fundamentals
- Lab 03 - Declarative Agents
- Lab 04 - Solutions
- Lab 05 - Prebuilt Agents
- Lab 06 - Custom Agent
- Lab 07 - Topics and Triggers
- Lab 08 - Adaptive Cards
- Lab 09 - Agent Flows
- Lab 10 - Event Triggers
- Lab 11 - Publish Agent
- Lab 12 - Licensing

Day 2: Operative scenario

Day 2 should feel like a progression, not a reset. Anchor the day around the Hiring Agent scenario and repeatedly connect new material to business readiness, governance, and operational quality.

Suggested pattern:

1. Reconfirm prerequisites and Day 1 carry-forward.
2. Reorient participants to the Hiring Agent business process.

3. Build through instruction quality, connected agents, automation, model choices, safety, multimodal processing, Dataverse grounding, document generation, MCP integration, user feedback, and evaluation on the shared core path.
4. Close with architecture review, governance discussion, and next-step planning while developers who are caught up can branch to the optional VS Code workflow.

Recommended labs to reference:

Shared core path:

- Lab 13 - Hiring Agent Setup
- Lab 14 - Agent Instructions
- Lab 15 - Multi-Agent
- Lab 16 - Trigger Automation
- Lab 17 - Model Selection
- Lab 18 - Content Moderation
- Lab 19 - Multimodal Prompts
- Lab 20 - Dataverse Grounding
- Lab 21 - Document Generation
- Lab 22 - MCP Integration
- Lab 23 - User Feedback
- Lab 24 - Agent Evaluation

Optional/stretch path:

- Lab 25 - VS Code Extension

Pacing guidance

Use a repeatable rhythm across both days:

- Demo first when a step has many clicks, permissions, or hidden dependencies.
- Let participants work first when the task is creative, exploratory, or easy to validate.
- Time-box concept sections to protect lab time.
- Pause every 60 to 90 minutes for visible status checks.
- Treat setup drift early; treat content drift later.

Recommended split:

- 35 to 40 percent instructor-led framing and demo.
- 50 to 60 percent guided hands-on work.
- 10 percent recap, Q&A, and reset time.

When to demo

Demo the full flow before participants touch the keyboard when:

- Entering a new tool surface for the first time.
- Creating environments, solutions, connections, or security-sensitive configuration.
- Troubleshooting a known failure mode.
- Showing publishing, trigger setup, MCP configuration, or evaluation setup.

When to let participants work

Let participants work without interruption when:

- Drafting prompts or instructions.
- Building topics, cards, and flows from a known pattern.
- Tuning grounding sources or response formatting.
- Running validation tests with a clear success criterion.

> **Tip:** Use short "demo, mirror, roam" cycles. Demo for 5 to 8 minutes, give 15 to 25 minutes to build, then roam and unblock tables.

Timing checkpoints

Day	Checkpoint	Target time	What should be true
Day 1	Welcome complete	09:30	Attendees are signed in, know outcomes, and understand the two-day arc.
Day 1	Environment ready	10:15	Copilot Studio access confirmed and core prerequisites validated.
Day 1	Foundation complete	11:30	Participants understand agent concepts and core Copilot Studio building blocks.
Day 1	Custom agent built	13:45	Most tables have a working agent with knowledge attached.
Day 1	Interaction layer complete	15:15	Topics, Adaptive Cards, and flows are functioning for most participants.
Day 1	Publish and recap	16:30	Participants have published or observed publishing and know Day 2 prerequisites.

Day	Checkpoint	Target time	What should be true
Day 2	Scenario reset complete	09:30	Hiring Agent architecture and prerequisites are clear to everyone.
Day 2	Multi-agent core built	11:15	Central agent and connected-agent pattern are working.
Day 2	Safety and grounding complete	14:00	Safety, model selection, multimodal, and Dataverse topics are covered.
Day 2	MCP, feedback, and evaluation complete	16:00	MCP configuration, feedback capture, evaluation flow, and the end-to-end scenario can be demonstrated.
Day 2	Final review	16:30	Deliverables reviewed, governance discussed, and next steps captured.

Troubleshooting strategy

Handle issues in this order:

1. Confirm identity, tenant, environment, and license.
2. Confirm participants are in the correct lab and using the expected account.
3. Reproduce the issue on the facilitator machine or demo tenant.
4. Decide whether the issue is local, tenant-wide, or service-related.
5. Route the participant to a recovery path that preserves momentum.

Useful recovery tactics:

- Pair blocked attendees with a working partner for observation-based learning.
- Keep screenshots or a completed demo environment ready for catch-up moments.
- If a licensing or tenant issue blocks a full exercise, switch the attendee to observe key checkpoints and continue later.
- For Day 2, allow participants who are behind to use a pre-staged Hiring Agent solution for later modules.

Escalation guidance

Escalate quickly when:

- Multiple attendees fail at the same step.
- Tenant-wide permissions or licensing are missing.
- Copilot Studio or Dataverse services appear degraded.

- Publishing, Teams, MCP, or evaluation configuration fails for reasons outside normal workshop setup.

Escalation playbook:

- Capture the exact step, screenshot, account type, and error text.
- Test with the facilitator demo account.
- Decide whether to continue with workaround, switch to demonstration, or skip to the next learning objective.
- Preserve the schedule; do not let a single environment issue consume an entire module.

> **Warning:** If publishing, MCP setup, or evaluation setup fails across multiple attendees, convert the exercise to instructor demo mode and protect the rest of the day.

Break and lunch handling

Use breaks as operational checkpoints, not only downtime.

- Before each break, tell attendees exactly where they should pause.
- Display a slide or shared note with the current lab number and next restart point.
- Ask everyone to keep browser tabs open and avoid signing out unless required.
- Use lunch to validate the afternoon demo environment and spot-check accounts that were partially blocked in the morning.

Suggested rhythm:

- Morning break after setup or foundation content.
- Lunch after the first major build milestone.
- Afternoon break after the most complex hands-on segment.

Module-by-module facilitator notes

Day 1 modules

Welcome and setup

- Set expectations for mixed audiences and emphasize collaboration across roles.
- Confirm every participant can access the correct tenant and environment.
- Call out Lab 00 - Environment Setup early for any attendee who needs catch-up steps.

Agent concepts and fundamentals

- Keep this section practical.
- Translate concepts like grounding, orchestration, and autonomy into customer examples.
- Ask each audience type what success looks like in their role.

Declarative agents, solutions, and reusable patterns

- Show the fastest path to visible value first.
- Explain when declarative agents are sufficient, how solutions package shared assets, and when prebuilt agents accelerate delivery.
- Remind [Developer] participants that solution packaging becomes important as soon as they move past experimentation.

Custom agent build and grounding

- Use Lab 06 - Custom Agent as the first long Day 1 build block and checkpoint working knowledge attachment halfway through.
- Connect the custom agent back to the earlier solution story so participants understand what should travel together between environments.
- Reinforce that makers shape behavior, IT pros validate access, and developers think ahead about reuse.

Topics, cards, and flows

- Demo one end-to-end pattern before participants build.
- Encourage [Maker] attendees to focus on clarity and user experience.
- Encourage [IT Pro] attendees to watch connectors, governance, and approval patterns.

Triggers and publishing

- Keep the publishing sequence tightly guided.
- Explain differences between “works in studio” and “ready for business use.”
- Use this moment to introduce Day 2 as the enterprise extension of Day 1.

Licensing, credits, ROI, and Day 2 prep

- Treat Lab 12 - Licensing as a discussion-first close that explains Copilot Credits, user licensing, and where capacity is still consumed.
- Use scenario-based ROI questions so mixed audiences can connect commercial readiness back to the build they just finished.
- End with the exact Day 2 prerequisite check so attendees know the shared core path comes first tomorrow.

Day 2 modules

Hiring Agent setup and instructions

- Re-anchor the room on the scenario and business value.
- Stress that instruction quality drives downstream behavior.
- Connect instruction writing to testing and governance, not just creativity.

Multi-agent orchestration and triggers

- Draw the architecture on a whiteboard or slide.
- Revisit which agent owns which responsibility.
- Help participants resist over-engineering; simple handoffs are easier to debug.

Model selection, safety, and multimodal

- Frame model choice as a trade-off between cost, speed, and quality.
- Treat safety as a first-class requirement, not an add-on.
- Encourage [IT Pro] attendees to lead the governance discussion here.

Dataverse, document generation, MCP, and evaluation

- Remind attendees that enterprise grounding changes both usefulness and risk profile.
- Demo MCP setup once, keep user feedback and evaluation on the shared core path, then release advanced tables only to the optional VS Code branch after Lab 24.
- If time is tight, prioritize grounding and safety over optional embellishments.

Feedback and wrap-up

- End with measurable deliverables, not just a feature tour.
- Keep user feedback and evaluation with the full room; Lab 25 - VS Code Extension is the optional developer-only stretch path once the core build is complete.
- Ask participants what would be required to productionize the scenario in their organization.
- Close on badge guidance, next labs, and ownership after the workshop.

End-of-day outcomes

Day 1 outcomes

- Participants understand core Copilot Studio concepts.
- Participants have completed or observed the core Recruit build path.
- Participants know whether they are ready for Day 2 or need additional practice.

Day 2 outcomes

- Participants can explain the Hiring Agent architecture and supporting governance controls.
- Participants have worked through the shared core path of enterprise-focused agent patterns.
- Participants leave with a practical adoption conversation for their own environment.

Facilitator closeout checklist

- Capture attendance, blockers, and follow-up owners.
- Note which labs were completed versus demonstrated.
- Record tenant or licensing issues that need post-event remediation.
- Share the participant guides and direct attendees to the relevant lab folders for continued practice.